

01 SMALL TALK

What is the last thing you bought online?

Do you enjoy shopping, or do you find it a little tiring?

Do you have a favorite store you go back to again and again?

02 POP QUIZ — DOES THIS SOUND NATURAL?

- ① ~~"I bought it because it's a famous maker."~~
✓ "I bought it because it's a well-known brand."

'maker'는 콩글리시예요. 브랜드는 그냥 'brand'라고 해요.

- ② ~~"This product has good cost performance."~~
✓ "This product is great value for money."

'cost performance'(가성비)는 영어로 안 써요. 'value for money'나 'worth the price'로 풀어요.

- ③ ~~"I want to buy a brand bag."~~
✓ "I want to buy a designer bag."

'brand bag'는 콩글리시예요. 명품은 'designer'나 'luxury'를 써요.

03 오늘의 워업

각 라운드 손가락으로 A 또는 B. 한 라운드마다 한 명 짧게 이유.

WARM-UP

Would You Rather (5분)

- | | | | |
|---|--|----|---|
| 1 | Recommend a trendy brand everyone talks about now | VS | Recommend a quiet brand you have used for years |
| 2 | Buy a product because it is going viral online | VS | Buy a product because a friend says it really lasts |
| 3 | Pay more for something that stays good for a long time | VS | Pay less for something cute you will replace soon |
| 4 | Recommend a famous brand so it feels safe | VS | Recommend a small brand you secretly love |

Korean Brands Worth Recommending — Hype or Real Quality?

BACKGROUND

한국 브랜드를 친구에게 추천할 때는 내가 혼자 쓸 때보다 기준이 조금 더 엄격해져요. 나 혼자 만족하는 건 괜찮지만, 남에게 추천했다가 품질이 별로이거나 유행만 앞선 제품이면 괜히 민망해질 수 있어요. 요즘은 디자인이나 화제성뿐 아니라 오래 쓰는지, 가격이 납득되는지, 실제 생활에서 손이 가는지까지 보게 돼요. 좋은 추천은 브랜드의 유명함보다 사용 후에도 만족이 남는지에 더 가까워요.

READ BEFORE WE TALK

Recommending a Korean brand to a friend carries a small social risk. Buying something for yourself is one thing; telling someone else, "You should try this," attaches your taste and trust to the product. A brand may look stylish online, have nice packaging, or be popular for a while, but a recommendation feels safer when the quality holds up in real life. People notice durability, comfort, price, and whether the product still feels good after the first excitement fades. The difference between hype and real quality becomes clearer when your friend spends money because of your suggestion. If the item is truly useful and lasts, recommending it feels easy. If it is mostly hype, people may feel embarrassed later. That is why real quality matters more when the recommendation goes to a friend.

WORDS YOU MIGHT NEED

it's worth the price — 그 값을 한다

it's just hype — 그냥 거품이다

value for money — 가성비가 좋다

it holds up over time — 오래 써도 괜찮다

take it with a grain of salt — 적당히 걸러 듣다

a red flag — 경고 신호

TRY THESE PHRASES

I lean more toward a friend's recommendation because ____.

It depends on the product, but usually I check ____ first.

Looking back, one time I recommended ____ and it taught me ____.

Honestly, yes — I once told my friend to try ____, but ____.

EASY ENTRY

- 1 Are you more of a 'stick to the Korean brands I already trust' or a 'always chasing the new hyped one' shopper?
- 2 When was the last time you bought a Korean brand mostly because of the hype?
- 3 Quick — when a Korean brand suddenly goes viral, are you an early buyer, a wait-and-see type, or a 'never bother' type?
- 4 On a scale of 1 to 5, how often do you end up recommending a Korean brand to friends after you try it?

MAIN DISCUSSION

Q1. Do you trust a friend's recommendation more, or online reviews? Why?

I lean more toward a friend's recommendation because ____.

It depends on the product, but usually I check ____ first.

Q2. Have you ever recommended something and felt embarrassed later? What happened?

Looking back, one time I recommended ____ and it taught me ____.

Honestly, yes — I once told my friend to try ____, but ____.

Q3. What makes a product feel like real quality instead of just hype?

What makes it feel like real quality is ____, not just ____.

The way I see it, quality shows up after ____.

Q4. Would you recommend a trendy item even if you hadn't used it for long? Why or why not?

I'd say yes because ____, even if I haven't used it long.

When I think about it, recommending something new feels ____ because ____.

Q5. Which is hardest to recommend — fashion, food, or beauty? Why?

I'd say ____ is the hardest because ____.

Compared to the others, ____ feels harder to recommend since ____.